Chapter 5

Bohm and the reception of his ideas: The story was apparently told by Dresden in May 1989 at an American Physical Society (APS) meeting. However, there was no official record of Dresden's comments at that meeting. The story appears in F. David Peat 1997, *Infinite Potential: The Life and Times of David Bohm* (Addison Wesley Longman), p. 133; but Peat did not actually record Dresden's comments in real time at the APS meeting, and, though Peat claims that Dresden repeated his story in a letter to him later on, Peat was unable to produce the letter when asked. A somewhat different account of the same story appears in Cushing 1994, pp. 156–157; although Cushing doesn't name Dresden, it is clearly very similar to the story recounted by Peat, and Cushing was on the same panel as Dresden at the 1989 APS meeting. Even if we grant that Peat and Cushing are accurately representing Dresden's comments from 1989, we are ultimately relying on a single person's recollection of events nearly forty years after they occurred. This story must, at best, be taken with a sizable grain of salt.

no clear evidence: A sampling (not a comprehensive list) of Peat's errors (1997):

- He claims Bohm harbored doubts about the Copenhagen interpretation during his early days at Berkeley; Bohm explicitly denies this in his interview with Wilkins, stating that he had no such doubts until he arrived at Princeton.
- He claims Feynman was one of Oppenheimer's PhD students at Berkeley with Bohm. Feynman never attended Berkeley.
- He claims that Fritz Zwicky supposedly spoke every language with an accent, even his native Russian. Zwicky was Swiss. That claim was originally made about George Gamow.
- He claims Einstein called Bohm's theory a "nursery rhyme" in a letter to Max Born. Einstein said no such thing; he was clearly referring to his own paper as a "nursery rhyme."
- He repeatedly claims Bohm testified in front of HUAC in 1950. That happened in 1949.

Moreover, Peat did not record any of the interviews he conducted